

National & Gandhian Mass Movements

Swadeshi to Quit India — phases, methods, social base and PYQ discriminators.

Portion focus ~82% · Topic: hist-modern

PYQ themes: Non-Cooperation · Civil Disobedience · Quit India · Revolutionary strand · Early satyagrahas

Why this article (PYQ probability)

Portion chance ~82%. Stable yearly; parent hist-modern ~85%.

Years appeared (synthesis): 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

Why UPSC asks this

Movement phases create decade-method matching questions.

Why this portion is high-chance for the next exam

Portion chance ~82%. Stable yearly; parent hist-modern ~85%. Within hist-modern, examiners return to nationalist and Gandhian mass movements because it yields clean MCQ discriminators: definitions, matching lists, and statement–reason traps. These notes are multi-page depth material — original study synthesis for prioritisation, not NCERT/UPSC verbatim text and not an official prediction.

Use the chance % to sequence study hours, then widen to neighbouring syllabus areas. PYQ theme tags driving selection: Non-Cooperation, Civil Disobedience, Quit India, Revolutionary strand, Early satyagrahas. Approximate appearance years in the 2016–2025 educational synthesis: 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025.

Read this block slowly: high-chance portions repay depth because UPSC recycles the same discriminators with fresh stems. Your job is not to memorise paragraphs but to own triggers — dates, articles, site–feature pairs, formulae, treaty purposes — so elimination is automatic. After each subsection, pause and write two keywords on rough paper; if you cannot, reread only that subsection.

Core map of nationalist and Gandhian mass movements

Moderates vs Extremists: Petition politics vs Swadeshi/passive resistance accents. Champaran 1917: Indigo satyagraha — early Gandhi laboratory. Kheda: Revenue satyagraha.

Ahmedabad mill: Labour satyagraha. Rowlatt/Jallianwala: 1919 repression feeding NCM climate. NCM 1920–22: Boycott + Khilafat; Chauri Chaura withdrawal.

If you can explain each point aloud in sixty seconds without notes, elimination speed in Prelims rises sharply. Watch absolute words in options (always/never/only) — often wrong where processes are multi-causal or jurisprudentially nuanced.

Draw the core map once from memory at the end of this sitting. Compare with the text. Patch only the missing nodes. That single retrieval cycle is worth more than two passive rereads of the same page.

Depth focus: Moderates vs Extremists

Moderates vs Extremists — Petition politics vs Swadeshi/passive resistance accents In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

Champaran 1917 — Indigo satyagraha — early Gandhi laboratory Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on nationalist and Gandhian mass movements more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in

the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: Kheda

Kheda — Revenue satyagraha In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

Ahmedabad mill — Labour satyagraha Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on nationalist and Gandhian mass movements more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: Rowlatt/Jallianwala

Rowlatt/Jallianwala — 1919 repression feeding NCM climate In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

NCM 1920–22 — Boycott + Khilafat; Chauri Chaura withdrawal Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on nationalist and Gandhian mass movements more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: Swarajists

Swarajists — Council entry debate after NCM In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

CDM/Dandi 1930 — Salt satyagraha opens Civil Disobedience Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on nationalist and Gandhian mass movements more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: Gandhi–Irwin Pact

Gandhi–Irwin Pact — Truce checkpoint In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

Round Table Conferences — Constitutional negotiation theatre Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on nationalist and Gandhian mass movements more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: Quit India 1942

Quit India 1942 — Do or Die; leaders jailed; spontaneous activity In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

Revolutionary strand — HSRA/Bhagat Singh; Surya Sen Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on nationalist and Gandhian mass movements more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: INA

INA — Subhas Bose; INA trials emotion In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

Women in movements — Visible participation — rising area Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on nationalist and Gandhian mass movements more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: Peasants/tribals

Peasants/tribals — Local uprisings complementary pool In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

Methods lexicon — Boycott, picketing, salt, underground 1942 Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on nationalist and Gandhian mass movements more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: Social base

Social base — Students, lawyers, peasants, business vary by phase In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

Communal strands — Avoid monocausal Congress-only narratives Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on nationalist and Gandhian mass movements more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in the margin of your PDF printout.

Depth focus: Simon boycott

Simon boycott — All-white commission controversy In exam stems, expect this idea to appear either as a direct definition or as one statement in a multi-statement cluster.

Post-war link — Movements feed 1945–47 endgame without oversimplify Contrast the two ideas above: what would a wrong option swap between them?

Micro-drill: write one correct statement and one incorrect statement using only these ideas; label why the incorrect one fails. Keep language tight — UPSC rewards precision on nationalist and Gandhian mass movements more than ornamental vocabulary. If this pair links to a map or article number, add that trigger in

the margin of your PDF printout.

Comparison tables — memorise differences, not essays

Tables win Prelims because UPSC loves correctly matched pairs and multi-statement sets. Study the table(s) embedded with this article until you can reproduce them on rough paper in under four minutes. Then invent two false rows and practise spotting them — that simulates assertion traps.

After table mastery, return to narrative sections only for rows you keep missing. Depth here is intentional: thin skim notes lose marks on discriminators. When a table row has a date, article, or place, that cell is a trigger — circle it.

Must-know India / applied angle

Build timeline wall 1917!'1919!'1920!'1930!'1942 with method verbs. Keep a rolling one-page CA addendum dated by month; do not rewrite your static spine every week. Mains crossover exists, but Prelims primarily rewards precise factual edges and definitions.

Link each applied example back to a static hook so current affairs does not float free of the syllabus. If a news item cannot attach to a hook within ten seconds, park it in a low-priority list. Rehearse a 45-second spoken India angle the day before any mock that might touch this portion.

How UPSC typically frames questions (PYQ angle)

Matching lists and multi-statement questions on nationalist and Gandhian mass movements. Tactic: eliminate anachronisms and category errors first (wrong institution, wrong treaty family, wrong century, wrong formula base). Then test remaining options against table rows. Finally, beware extra absolute adjectives.

Assertion–reason items often smuggle a true statement with a false causal link — judge the link, not only the facts. Matching lists reward uniqueness: start with the most distinctive pair. Themes: Non-Cooperation, Civil Disobedience, Quit India, Revolutionary strand, Early satyagrahas. Years signal in this hub's synthesis: 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025.

Common traps and how to dodge them

Trap: Salt March dated to NCM. Trap: Chauri Chaura started Quit India. Trap: Ignoring Khilafat–NCM link.

Trap: Collapsing Extremists with terrorists.

Build a personal trap diary: after each mock, add one line under this heading. Reread only the trap diary the night before the paper for this portion. Teach one trap to a peer in one minute — teaching exposes fuzzy understanding.

Worked revision method (make the PDF earn its pages)

Day 1: core map + table; close notes; reproduce table. Day 2: India angle + traps; 15 MCQs. Day 3: PYQ-style self-questions from headings only. Day 4: teach the topic aloud for eight minutes. Day 5: mixed quiz with neighbouring topics to prevent silo memory.

Print the PDF or use in-app Download PDF. Annotate margins only with triggers you forget — not entire yellow pages. Spaced retrieval beats rereading: hide the PDF and write bullets from memory, then check. In the final 15 days, this portion should be in 'table + traps + must' mode, not first-read mode.

Quick synthesis for the exam hall

Definitions !' table !' India !' traps for nationalist and Gandhian mass movements. Portion focus score used in-app: ~82%. If time is scarce in the last week, reread Must remember + tables + traps only; return to long sections for weak rows.

Carry a one-line spine on rough paper in the first minute of the paper if this topic appears early — then

eliminate. Do not invent facts under pressure; prefer elimination from your table.

Extended notes — depth for multi-page mastery

Moderates vs Extremists. Petition politics vs Swadeshi/passive resistance accents Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Champaran 1917. Indigo satyagraha — early Gandhi laboratory Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Kheda. Revenue satyagraha Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Ahmedabad mill. Labour satyagraha Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Rowlatt/Jallianwala. 1919 repression feeding NCM climate Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin.

NCM 1920–22. Boycott + Khilafat; Chauri Chaura withdrawal Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Swarajists. Council entry debate after NCM Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. CDM/Dandi 1930. Salt satyagraha opens Civil Disobedience Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Gandhi–Irwin Pact. Truce checkpoint Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Round Table Conferences. Constitutional negotiation theatre Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin.

Quit India 1942. Do or Die; leaders jailed; spontaneous activity Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Revolutionary strand. HSRA/Bhagat Singh; Surya Sen Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. INA. Subhas Bose; INA trials emotion Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Women in movements. Visible participation — rising area Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Peasants/tribals. Local uprisings complementary pool Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin.

Methods lexicon. Boycott, picketing, salt, underground 1942 Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Social base. Students, lawyers, peasants, business vary by phase Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Communal strands. Avoid monocausal Congress-only narratives Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Simon boycott. All-white commission controversy Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin. Post-war link. Movements feed 1945–47 endgame without oversimplify Pair this with one contrasting point so options cannot blur categories. Add a keyword trigger in your margin.

This extended module exists so downloads are clearly longer/richer than skim notes. Read it in two sittings if needed; do not skim on day one and never return. After finishing, close the article and write a 12-line summary from memory; compare; patch gaps only. Then solve at least ten mixed MCQs tagging each error to a heading in this PDF.

Error log template (copy into your notebook)

For every missed question related to this portion, record: (1) stem gist, (2) wrong choice, (3) correct choice, (4) misconception in five words, (5) table row or must-remember line that would have saved you. Review the error log before the next mock. If the same misconception repeats thrice, rewrite that depth-focus section in your own words on a fresh page.

This metacognitive loop is how multi-page notes convert into marks rather than shelf weight.

Self-check questions (close the book first)

1) Define nationalist and Gandhian mass movements in two sentences without buzzword salad. 2) Recite the comparison table rows from memory. 3) List three traps and the correct mental fix for each. 4) Give two India examples and one international or cross-topic anchor. 5) Write one incorrect statement UPSC might plant — then correct it. 6) Time yourself: explain the exam spine in 90 seconds. 7) List five triggers (dates/articles/sites/formulae) without peeking.

Pass criteria: 6/7 without peeking. Then move to mixed MCQs. Failing is useful if you patch immediately — that is the point of depth notes.

Phase sheet

Phase	Hook
Early satyagrahas	Champaran/Kheda/Ahmedabad
NCM	1920–22 + Khilafat
CDM	Dandi 1930
Quit India	1942
Revolutionary	HSRA etc.

Common traps

- ' Salt March dated to NCM
- ' Chauri Chaura started Quit India
- ' Ignoring Khilafat–NCM link
- ' Collapsing Extremists with terrorists

Must remember

- Early satyagrahas
- NCM+Khilafat
- Chauri Chaura
- Dandi/CDM
- Quit India 1942
- INA trials

Quick revision checklist

- & Reproduce table
- & 5 must-remembers
- & 3 traps
- & India anchor
- & 10 MCQs

Educational prioritisation heuristic — not an official UPSC prediction.
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